



This article walks readers through the requisites of a good Web developer. For those who wish to make a career as a Web developer, it is a must-read!

Like many scientific concepts, the term Web 2.0 doesn't have a clear definition or boundary, but encompasses several principles. Primarily, it positions the Web as a platform, as software as a service and not as a packaged product. Tim O'Reilly has explained Web 2.0 in his landmark article by comparing trends that define Web 2.0. The complete article 'What is Web 2.0, Designs and patterns for the next generation of software' is available on <http://oreilly.com/pub/a/web2/archive/what-is-web-20.html?page=1>

Lack of a clear boundary is evident in startups, too, where developers handle user queries, provision servers and other hardware, etc. It's not uncommon to see a PHP guru trying to tame a heavily swapping VPS, installing the latest HTTP load balancer, deploying code to servers and performing several other tasks. This convergence is called 'DevOps' and is the Web 2.0 way of doing things. Having a fluid boundary makes it extremely difficult to clearly define the responsibilities and skills of a Web 2.0 developer. Most developers have a multitude of skills.

They spend a large portion of their day (and night!) writing code, refactoring, trying out code snippets, checking out technology news, and helping other developers on various forums—thus constantly pitching themselves against similar, bigger and brighter minds on the Web.

If you yearn to be a Web 2.0 developer and wish to make a mark in an industry that is evolving rapidly, you should first know that the older ways of crafting solutions might not yield productive artefacts, and you require new methodologies and tools to architect and deliver solutions. You should be willing to invest time and energy in learning new things to keep up, otherwise you risk being outdated. You should constantly read, learn and continue to build your arsenal to be successful. The following sections should help you get started on your journey to becoming a successful Web 2.0 developer.

Hardware and other gear

You should have access to a laptop/PC (the older the better and even Celeron is fine!). Then you require an Internet